

# MORNING BRIEFING — FRIDAY 7 AUGUST 2026

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## 2. IMPORTANT NEWS

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### **Iran floats restrictive Strait of Hormuz shipping draft, reviving risk-off tone and pushing oil sharply higher**

[Reuters](#) / [CNBC](#) / [Al Jazeera](#) • overnight Aug 6-7

After days of Iran-Oman talks that appeared close to a shipping-corridor deal, Iran's parliament is reportedly reviewing a more restrictive counter-draft barring US/Israeli-linked vessels and penalising "hostile" nations. Brent jumped ~4% to the low-\$80s, US equities closed lower Thursday, and Asian futures pointed to a cautious open. Binary risk into today: any confirmed de-escalation reverses the move fast; any fresh incident extends it.

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### **Kospi plunges 4.6% as AI-chip valuation reset hits Samsung, SK Hynix; circuit breaker triggered**

[Korea JoongAng Daily](#) / [Bloomberg](#) • Thursday Aug 6 session

Samsung Electronics -6.3%, SK Hynix -10.4%, SK Square -13.3% on renewed AI-capex profitability worries; a sell-side sidecar halted program trading. Friday's Kospi open rebounded (+1.1% to +1.85% intraday) before fading to roughly flat. Contagion risk into European chip names (ASML, STMicroelectronics) is the key watch item at the open.

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### **US July jobs report due 13:30 BST — today's dominant catalyst, consensus dispersion unusually wide**

[BLS](#) / [CNBC](#) / [FactSet](#) • scheduled 08:30 ET

Estimates range widely (roughly 83,000-120,000 across desks) after June's weak +57,000 print and a soft ADP private payrolls read of +44,000 (Aug 5, vs ~+70,000 expected). Unemployment seen ticking up to 4.2-4.3%. The report will be the primary driver of rates, the dollar and risk sentiment through the European afternoon.

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### **US earnings dispersion: Cloudflare +16%, Airbnb +8% after hours vs Fiserv -12%, DraftKings -3%**

[Bloomberg](#) / [Yahoo Finance](#) • after Thursday's US close

Cloudflare raised full-year EPS guidance to \$1.25-\$1.26 on AI-driven demand; Airbnb posted its strongest results in years. Fiserv slashed FY EPS guidance to \$7.20-\$7.40 from \$8.00-\$8.30; DraftKings missed on revenue. Sets up a clear AI/cloud-winners-vs-payments-losers rotation theme for European tech and payments names today.

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### **easyJet: Apollo's £5.4-5.7bn (£7.15/share) takeover now backed by founder Stelios Haji-Ioannou after Castlelake withdraws**

[CNBC](#) / [Benzinga](#) • Thursday Aug 6

Board unanimously recommends the all-cash offer; still needs shareholder vote, court sanction and multiple regulatory/FDI clearances across the UK, Germany, Austria, France, Italy, Spain, Malta and Egypt, with completion targeted Q1 2027. Largest UK aviation M&A story of the week; read-across positive for sector sentiment.

### 3. EUROPEAN FUTURES (PRE-OPEN)

| CONTRACT                        | LEVEL                 | INDICATIVE MOVE                                                  | COLLECTION TIME |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Euro Stoxx 50 futures           | ~6,326                | Cautious / lower bias — raw point-gap unreliable, see flag below | 06:00 BST       |
| DAX futures                     | ~26,270               | <b>+0.19% (24h)</b>                                              | 06:00 BST       |
| CAC 40 futures                  | ~8,360                | Cautious bias — raw point-gap unreliable, see flag below         | 06:00 BST       |
| FTSE 100 futures                | 10,446-10,508 (range) | Cautious bias — raw point-gap unreliable, see flag below         | 06:00 BST       |
| US context — pre-market futures |                       |                                                                  |                 |
| S&P 500 e-mini                  | n/a                   | <b>+0.67%</b>                                                    | 06:00 BST       |
| Nasdaq 100 e-mini               | ~29,540               | Mixed/uncertain — conflicting headlines same morning             | 06:00 BST       |
| Dow e-mini                      | n/a                   | <b>+0.60%</b>                                                    | 06:00 BST       |

Data quality flag: raw Euro Stoxx 50 / CAC 40 / FTSE 100 futures snapshots imply overnight gaps of roughly -3% to -4% versus Thursday's cash closes, which is inconsistent with the qualitative newsflow ("cautious, modest lower open expected") and looks like a contract-roll or data-timing artifact rather than a genuine move. Exact point levels are therefore not shown as firm expected moves — treat as n/a pending terminal confirmation. Qualitative read: Reuters wrap describes Asia/Europe futures as set for a modestly cautious, lower-biased open on Hormuz/oil risk and ahead of US payrolls, with DAX futures the outlier holding a small positive bias.

Opening bias is cautious. The Iran Hormuz-draft headline and the Kospi chip rout are pulling against a firm US futures tone (S&P/Dow futures both modestly positive). Today's US jobs report at 13:30 BST is the swing factor for the rest of the session.

#### 4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (6 AUGUST 2026)

| INDEX         | CLOSE                                            | CHANGE                                  |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Euro Stoxx 50 | 6,503                                            | +0.4% (fresh all-time intraday high)    |
| DAX 40        | 26,140                                           | +0.05%                                  |
| CAC 40        | ~8,670-8,700 (exact close n/a — source conflict) | Record intraday high set                |
| FTSE 100      | 10,920.23                                        | +0.29% (third straight gaining session) |

European equities extended their record run Thursday, led by strong Q2 earnings across insurers, banks and industrials (Rolls-Royce, BAE Systems, Deutsche Bank, UBS, ING all beat). CAC 40's precise closing print could not be confirmed with confidence — two candidate figures (8,669 / 8,674) may reflect Wednesday's close rather than Thursday's; both are consistent with a record-territory session near 8,700.

#### 5. US MARKETS — YESTERDAY'S SESSION (6 AUGUST 2026)

| INDEX                        | CLOSE     | CHANGE               | NOTE                                                              |
|------------------------------|-----------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| S&P 500                      | 7,709.96  | −0.18%               | Second consecutive decline after record highs earlier in the week |
| Dow Jones Industrial Average | 53,885.10 | −464.02 pts / −0.85% | Ended a 5-day winning streak                                      |
| Nasdaq Composite             | 26,348.35 | −0.06%               | —                                                                 |

**Tone:** Risk-off pause after a strong rally that had pushed the S&P 500 above 7,700 for the first time earlier in the week. Trigger was Iran's restrictive Hormuz draft reviving Middle East/oil-supply risk, compounded by positioning ahead of Friday's jobs report.

**Leading sectors:** Energy (+1%+, best performer; ExxonMobil ~+2%, Chevron ~+1% on the oil spike), Information Technology (+0.3%).

**Lagging sectors:** Real Estate, Materials and Industrials, each roughly −1%. American Airlines fell 2.1% on fuel-cost pressure.

**Key takeaway:** A genuine pause, not a reversal — oil-driven inflation risk and event risk (NFP) dominated over an otherwise constructive earnings backdrop (Cloudflare, Airbnb).

## 6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION

| INDEX              | LEVEL                                                | CHANGE                                                                                           |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nikkei 225         | 65,683.26 (Thu close)                                | −0.93% Thu; Fri close n/a, futures pointed to a modest further decline                           |
| Hang Seng          | 25,530.28 (Thu close); ~25,436.81 tentative Fri read | −1.49% Thu; ~−1.85% Fri (single-sourced, unconfirmed)                                            |
| Shanghai Composite | 3,900.4 (Thu); 3,908.62 (Fri)                        | +0.57% Thu; +0.21% Fri — bucking regional weakness                                               |
| Kospi              | 6,296.38 (Thu close); 6,307.40 (Fri, last read)      | −4.58% Thu (circuit breaker triggered); Fri choppy, opened +1.1%, peaked +1.85%, faded to +0.17% |

Overall tone cautious to mixed. Thursday's Kospi rout (Samsung -6.3%, SK Hynix -10.4%, Kioxia -10% intraday) followed a broader AI/semiconductor valuation reset that began in late July, when a single session reportedly wiped over \$1 trillion from global chip stocks. Friday's rebound attempt in Korea faded through the session, underlining fragile sentiment. Shanghai's resilience (+0.21%) stands out against the regional grain. Drivers: (1) continuing AI-capex profitability doubts centred on Korean chipmakers, (2) the Hormuz shipping-risk headline pushing oil and safe-haven flows, (3) caution ahead of the US jobs report.

## 7. COMMODITIES

| COMMODITY                            | LEVEL                                    | CHANGE                                                         | TIME      |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Brent (ICE, USD/bbl)                 | ~82.5-83.3                               | +~4% (Thu)                                                     | Thu close |
| WTI (NYMEX, USD/bbl)                 | ~77.5-77.9                               | +~3% (Thu)                                                     | Thu close |
| Gold (XAU/USD, USD/oz)               | 4,268-4,300                              | 4th straight up session, +~6% on the week; 7-week high         | Thu close |
| Natural gas — Henry Hub (USD/MMBtu)  | n/a — not reliably confirmed for Aug 6/7 | Last confirmed range ~2.9-3.3 (July)                           | —         |
| Natural gas — European TTF (EUR/MWh) | 53.62                                    | +2.33%                                                         | Thu close |
| Copper (COMEX, USD/lb)               | ~6.71                                    | Near record; direction of latest tick ambiguous across sources | Thu close |

Oil's sharp Thursday jump is entirely Hormuz-headline driven: Iran's more restrictive shipping draft reversed several sessions of softer prices tied to earlier Iran-Oman deal optimism. Gold's rally is a dual story — weak US labour data (ADP +44,000 in July, well below expectations) easing Fed-tightening odds, layered on Hormuz safe-haven demand. Copper remains near record levels on tight supply/robust demand, though the exact day-on-day direction is not reliably confirmed across sources. Any Hormuz de-escalation headline today would be a fast, sizeable reversal risk for both oil and gold.

## 8. RATES & FX

| INSTRUMENT         | LEVEL                                  | CHANGE                                                                                | TIME            |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| US Treasury 10yr   | ~4.60-4.67%                            | <b>+~6bp (Thu)</b>                                                                    | Thu close       |
| German Bund 10yr   | ~3.1% (approximate, precise print n/a) | Easing from July highs (~15yr-high area)                                              | Thu/Fri approx. |
| EUR/USD            | 1.15-1.16 (sources: 1.1519 / 1.1557)   | <b>-0.3%</b>                                                                          | Thu close       |
| GBP/USD            | 1.3451                                 | <b>-0.11%</b>                                                                         | Thu close       |
| DXY (Dollar Index) | 99.76                                  | <b>+0.09% Thu, but near a 7-week low and on course for its worst week in 3 months</b> | Thu close       |

US yields ticked up Thursday on the Hormuz-driven oil spike reviving inflation risk, even as weak ADP data argues the other way — a genuine crosscurrent heading into today's payrolls report. The Bund has eased back from its July sell-off highs as European rates track the same push-pull between oil-driven inflation risk and growth caution. Dollar index softness (worst week in three months) is the dominant FX theme; EUR/USD and GBP/USD both slipped modestly Thursday despite the broader dollar weakness, reflecting the risk-off tone in European hours.

## 9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

### YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES (6 AUGUST 2026)

| ISSUER | CURRENCY | SIZE | MATURITY | COUPON/SPREAD | NOTES |
|--------|----------|------|----------|---------------|-------|
|--------|----------|------|----------|---------------|-------|

No confirmed EUR corporate IG/HY/SSA/financials deal priced specifically on 6 August 2026 could be sourced from open web search — requires GlobalCapital Primary Market Monitor / IFR / Bloomberg terminal access to confirm same-day pricing.

Recent comparable context (not confirmed for 6 Aug specifically, background only): CaixaBank €1.25bn SNP 11NC10 at ms+108bp with >€6.5bn book (Jan 2026); MPS €750m covered bond at 30bp over reference, €2.4bn book (~3.2x); Iberdrola's 5th 2026 bond transaction, a USD 525m print via its US subsidiary in August.

### PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY & THIS WEEK

August is seasonally the quietest month for European primary issuance and this week fits that pattern: the EU has cut its EU-Bills auction cadence to once monthly for August (vs. the normal twice-monthly), and France's 2026 sovereign syndication programme is already complete after April's record €10bn green OAT. German government supply for August is forecast at €70-80bn gross (LBBW), with Schatz (€5bn, 25 Aug), Bobl (€5.5bn, 11 Aug) and 10yr Bund (€6bn, 19 Aug) auctions on the calendar. No corporate/FIG mandate or roadshow specific to the week of 7 August was found in open sources. By contrast, the US IG market is running hot: the week of 3 August was tracking toward \$19.71bn of supply, pace consistent with a record issuance month.

### KEY CREDIT SPREADS

| INDEX                                             | LEVEL                                              | MOVE / DIRECTION                       |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| iTraxx Europe Main 5yr                            | n/a                                                | Requires Bloomberg/ICE terminal access |
| iTraxx Europe Crossover 5yr                       | 318bp (last confirmed print, mid-May 2026 — stale) | No August reading available            |
| CDX.NA.IG 5yr (USD)                               | ~81bp (late July 2026 — stale)                     | No confirmed Aug print                 |
| Avg euro corporate IG spread (iBoxx € Corp proxy) | n/a                                                | Requires terminal access               |

European sovereign yields sold off sharply through July 2026 (largest monthly move since March, Bund yields toward 15-year highs) before partially reversing in early August as oil/Hormuz-negotiation optimism briefly cooled inflation concern — that reversal itself looks at risk given Thursday's Hormuz-draft headline. Credit spreads plausibly moved in sympathy with this rates volatility, but no verified iTraxx/iBoxx print for early August could be sourced; do not infer a number.

### COMMENTARY

The European primary window is technically open but seasonally thin this week — nothing about investor appetite looks constrained: recent deals across covered bonds (H1 2026 EUR covered issuance €121.7bn, +21.2% YoY), SNP (CaixaBank's largest-ever euro senior book) and sovereigns (France's €10bn green OAT drew a >€113bn book) all point to well-oversubscribed books whenever issuers do print. 2026 bank supply is forecast lighter than 2025 (SNP

€125bn vs €140bn; total senior unsecured €205bn), consistent with a calendar-driven rather than demand-driven lull. Skew toward industrials, transport and energy issuance should resume once the market gets past today's NFP print and any further Hormuz clarity; a confirmed de-escalation would be the more likely catalyst for a September-style pickup in mandates, not August itself.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR TODAY (7 AUGUST 2026)

| TIME (BST)          | REGION  | INDICATOR                                     | CONSENSUS / ACTUAL                                              | IMPORTANCE |
|---------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 07:00<br>(released) | Germany | Industrial Production, June (MoM)             | Actual <b>-1.9% vs -0.5% consensus — miss</b>                   | HIGH       |
| 07:00<br>(released) | Germany | Trade Balance, June                           | Actual <b>€14.9bn vs €17.3bn consensus — miss</b>               | MEDIUM     |
| 13:30               | US      | Nonfarm Payrolls, July                        | Wide dispersion across desks, ~83,000-120,000; not yet released | HIGH       |
| 13:30               | US      | Unemployment Rate, July                       | Consensus 4.2-4.3%; not yet released                            | HIGH       |
| 13:30               | US      | Average Hourly Earnings, July                 | Consensus +0.3% MoM / +3.5% YoY; not yet released               | MEDIUM     |
| Intraday, n/a       | US      | Fed speaker — St. Louis Fed President Musalem | Recent stance hawkish-leaning; would have preferred a July hike | MEDIUM     |
| ~17:00              | US      | Baker Hughes Rig Count (weekly)               | No consensus published; last week Total Rigs 588 (+1)           | MEDIUM     |

Germany's soft industrial production and trade balance prints (both released this morning) reinforce a weak-manufacturing narrative for the eurozone's largest economy. The session's clear focal point is the 13:30 BST US jobs report, whose unusually wide consensus range reflects genuine two-way uncertainty after a soft ADP print and volatile recent NFP revisions.

## 11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

| COMPANY    | MARKET             | EVENT                                                                                                                                                         | TIME                 |
|------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Allianz SE | Xetra<br>(Germany) | Q2/H1 2026 results — Morgan Stanley sees group operating profit ~4.3% below consensus (est. €4.41bn); FY guidance €17.4bn ± €1bn reaffirmed after a record Q1 | Pre-market<br>Europe |
| Munich Re  | Xetra<br>(Germany) | Final H1 2026 results — preliminary Q2 net profit €2.2bn already beat (€1.786bn est.), H1 net result €3.9bn, FY target €6.3bn reaffirmed                      | Pre-market<br>Europe |

Two large German insurers headline today's European calendar. Global aggregators indicate roughly 70-85 companies reporting worldwide today, but a full itemised list beyond these two confirmed European names could not be sourced (paywalled aggregators). Recently reported names still moving sentiment into today: HSBC, BP, Persimmon (+~4% on beat), Glencore, ArcelorMittal, Barclays, Lloyds, NatWest, Rolls-Royce, BAE Systems, Deutsche Bank, UBS and ING — a broadly strong European Q2 season so far.

## 12. STOCKS TO WATCH

|                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>easyJet (EZJ.L) — Aviation</b>                         | Apollo's firm £5.4-5.7bn (£7.15/share) cash takeover now backed by founder Stelios Haji-Ioannou after rival bidder Castlelake withdrew; board unanimously recommends. Long regulatory path ahead (multi-jurisdiction clearances), completion targeted Q1 2027. | <b>Up (deal support)</b>                                |
| <b>Allianz (ALV.DE) — Banks/Insurance</b>                 | Q2 results due today; Morgan Stanley flags operating profit risk roughly 4.3% below broader consensus.                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Down / volatile on results</b>                       |
| <b>Munich Re (MUV2.DE) — Banks/Insurance</b>              | Final H1 results due; preliminary Q2 beat (€2.2bn net profit) already partly priced in — watch for guidance detail in the final release.                                                                                                                       | <b>Neutral / mild upside</b>                            |
| <b>Rolls-Royce (RR.L) — Aerospace &amp; Defense</b>       | FY guidance raised to £4.7-4.9bn (from £4.0-4.2bn); Power Systems data-centre order growth +50% H1. Momentum strong but valuation increasingly stretched after the run.                                                                                        | <b>Neutral / mixed — momentum vs valuation</b>          |
| <b>BAE Systems (BA.L) — Aerospace &amp; Defense</b>       | Raised FY2026 underlying earnings growth guidance to 10-12% (from 9-11%) on defence-spending tailwinds.                                                                                                                                                        | <b>Up (momentum)</b>                                    |
| <b>Glencore (GLEN.L) — Metals &amp; Mining</b>            | Berenberg initiated coverage at Buy, 380p target (~21% upside), naming it top mining pick.                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Up</b>                                               |
| <b>Anglo American / Antofagasta — Metals &amp; Mining</b> | Both cut by brokers after strong rallies (Anglo to Hold at Berenberg, Antofagasta to Neutral at UBS) on valuation grounds, even as copper trades near record levels — a genuinely mixed signal for the sector today.                                           | <b>Down / neutral (valuation-driven downgrades)</b>     |
| <b>Saipem / Subsea7 ("Saipem7") — Energy</b>              | Binding merger in place (combined backlog >\$50bn), but TechnipFMC, ExxonMobil and Petrobras have petitioned Brazil's antitrust regulator (Cade) to intervene — a live regulatory overhang.                                                                    | <b>Volatile / downside risk on regulatory headlines</b> |
| <b>ZIM Integrated Shipping (ZIM) — Shipping</b>           | Hapag-Lloyd's proposed \$35/share cash acquisition cleared by Australia's ACCC — one more regulatory hurdle down; stock +14.1% YTD.                                                                                                                            | <b>Up (deal de-risking)</b>                             |

### 13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

#### MACRO

**Fed — internal split ahead of NFP:** July FOMC held rates at 3.50-3.75% with dissents; Minneapolis Fed's Kashkari has said it's "time to raise rates," even as a soft ADP print (+44,000 July) argues the dovish case. St. Louis Fed's Musalem, speaking today, has said he would have preferred a July hike and flagged inflation credibility risk. Genuine two-way uncertainty heading into the jobs report.

**ECB — hiked in June, held in July:** First hike since 2023 in June (deposit rate to 2.25%), held at that level in July. Eurozone HICP inflation 2.8% YoY in June (down from 3.2% in May); ECB's own forecasts see a return to 2% only in late 2027.

**BoE — hawkish hold:** Bank Rate held at 3.75% on 30 July for a fifth consecutive meeting, 6-3 vote (three members wanted a hike to 4%) on concern that higher energy prices could sustain inflation. UK CPI at 2.6% YoY in June. Next decision 17 September.

**BoJ:** Held its policy rate at 1% in late July (8-1 vote), warning core inflation is likely to run "clearly above" its 2% target.

#### CORPORATE

**US earnings dispersion:** Cloudflare (+16% AH) and Airbnb (+8% AH) beat and raised guidance on AI/travel demand; Fiserv (−12%) and DraftKings (−3%) missed, Fiserv cutting FY EPS guidance sharply. A clean AI/cloud-winners-vs-payments-laggards split.

**Kospi chip rout:** Samsung Electronics −6.3%, SK Hynix −10.4%, SK Square −13.3% on AI-capex profitability concerns — the latest and sharpest leg of a valuation reset that began in late July across global semiconductor names.

**easyJet takeover:** Apollo's £5.4-5.7bn offer now has founder backing after Castlelake's withdrawal — the largest live UK aviation M&A situation.

**European earnings season broadly strong:** Rolls-Royce, BAE Systems, Deutsche Bank, UBS and ING all beat expectations in recent weeks; Allianz and Munich Re report today.

#### POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

**Strait of Hormuz risk flare-up:** Iran's more restrictive draft shipping-corridor plan reverses recent Iran-Oman de-escalation optimism, barring US/Israeli-linked vessels. This sits within the broader 2026 Iran war (ongoing since 28 February), with Houthi forces claiming an attack on a Saudi oil tanker and continued fighting in Yemen. The single largest swing factor for oil, gold and risk sentiment today.

**US tariff actions:** Section 338 tariffs on Canadian goods (50% on an estimated \$16-20bn of dairy, alcohol, furniture and other products) take effect 19 August. A 100% Section 232 tariff on patented pharmaceutical products/APIs took effect 31 July for some companies, with a further compliance deadline of 29 September for others.

**US-China:** The tariff-truce extension holds until 10 November, removing near-term trade-war escalation risk. July Chinese trade data beat sharply (exports +23.9% YoY, imports +27.5% YoY per Xinhua), a positive global-demand signal that partly offsets the Kospi-driven risk-off tone.

## 14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

### TODAY'S TOP 5

#### 1. US July jobs report, 13:30 BST

Unusually wide consensus (83k-120k) after a soft ADP print. The session's dominant catalyst for rates, dollar and equities.

#### 2. Strait of Hormuz headline risk

Iran's restrictive shipping draft has oil near \$83. Any de-escalation or fresh incident swings risk assets sharply in either direction intraday.

#### 3. Asia chip-sector rebound attempt

Kospi's Friday bounce faded through the session after Thursday's 4.6% rout. Watch for contagion into ASML, STMicroelectronics at the European open.

#### 4. US earnings reaction flow-through

Cloudflare/Airbnb beats vs Fiserv/DraftKings misses shape sector rotation into European tech and payments names.

#### 5. Allianz & Munich Re results

Two large German insurers report; Allianz flagged as at risk of a consensus miss by Morgan Stanley.

### THIS WEEK'S TOP 5

#### 1. Peak Q2 earnings week continues

US mega-cap tail and European insurers/industrials still reporting; earnings dispersion remains the dominant equity driver.

#### 2. Semiconductor contagion risk

Whether the Kospi-led AI-capex valuation reset spreads further into European and US chip names in the days ahead.

#### 3. Hormuz negotiation trajectory

Iran-Oman talks vs. the more restrictive counter-draft — resolution either way is a major driver for oil and rates this week.

#### 4. European equities' record-high run

Euro Stoxx 50 and STOXX 600 at all-time highs; test is whether the rally extends or reverses given Asian tech weakness.

#### 5. Post-NFP Fed repricing

How markets recalibrate the Fed rate path after today's data, against oil-driven inflation risk and a genuinely split FOMC.

### THIS MONTH'S TOP 5

#### 1. Section 338 Canada tariffs, 19 August

50% tariffs on ~\$16-20bn of Canadian goods take effect; watch for retaliation or legal challenges.

#### 2. US July CPI, 12 August

Key inflation read shaping Fed rate-path expectations ahead of Jackson Hole.

#### 3. Jackson Hole Symposium, 27-29 August

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's remarks will be closely watched for policy signals amid the internal FOMC split.

#### 4. Nvidia earnings, 26 August

A major bellwether for the AI-capex debate that just rattled Korean chip stocks.

#### 5. Pharma tariff deadline, 29 September, and September central bank meetings

Remaining pharma Section 232 compliance deadline, plus BoE (17 Sep) and ECB positioning into year-end.

## 15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

### 1 DAY

**US jobs report (13:30 BST):** Wide consensus dispersion means a large surprise in either direction is plausible — the main source of intraday volatility.

**Hormuz headlines:** Any confirmed de-escalation or fresh incident is a fast, binary move for oil, gold and safe-haven flows.

**Asia chip follow-through:** Whether Friday's Kospi rebound holds or fades further, and whether it spreads into European semis at the open.

**German data miss:** Weak industrial production and trade balance reinforce eurozone manufacturing softness; watch EUR reaction.

### 1 WEEK

**Earnings continuation:** More European insurers/industrials and the US earnings tail reporting through the week.

**Semiconductor contagion:** Key test for ASML, STMicroelectronics and other AI-infrastructure beneficiaries after Korea's rout.

**Hormuz resolution path:** Iran-Oman talks remain fluid; a confirmed reopening or a fresh escalation would be week-defining for energy and rates.

**Post-NFP Fed repricing:** How the FOMC's internal hawk/dove split evolves once today's data is in hand.

### 1 MONTH

**19 Aug:** Section 338 Canada tariffs take effect — watch for retaliation.

**12 Aug:** US CPI (July) — sets the inflation backdrop into Jackson Hole.

**27-29 Aug:** Jackson Hole Symposium — Fed Chair Warsh's first major public remarks since the summer's rate-path debate.

**26 Aug:** Nvidia earnings — the key AI-capex bellwether after the Kospi-led valuation reset.

**Late Sept:** BoE (17 Sep) and ECB meetings, plus the 29 Sep pharma tariff compliance deadline.

## PRIMARY SOURCES USED

- Reuters / Bloomberg / CNBC / CNN — Strait of Hormuz newsflow, Iran-Oman talks, US jobs report preview, Fed speaker commentary
- Korea JoongAng Daily / BigGo Finance / Seoul Economic Daily / Tradingkey — Kospi session detail, chip-sector rout
- Xinhua — China July trade data
- TheStreet / Yahoo Finance / Washington Post — US index closes, Thursday 6 August
- Investing.com / Barchart / Benzinga — European and US futures levels
- Trading Economics / FXStreet / FX Leaders — commodities, rates, FX levels
- CNBC / mediacenter.adp.com — ADP private payrolls, NFP consensus previews (FactSet, Kiplinger, Continuum Economics)
- LBBW Bonds Weekly / European Commission funding plans / ING Think — DCM pipeline and supply forecasts
- FXStreet — German industrial production and trade balance releases
- MarketScreener / Reinsurance News / Insurance Journal — Allianz and Munich Re earnings previews
- CNBC / Benzinga / paddleyourownkanoo.com — easyJet / Apollo takeover

- Euronews — European equities record highs, 2026 sector performers

Data collected automatically between 05:00 and 06:45 BST on 7 August 2026 via open-source web research. Several data points are marked n/a where a figure could not be reliably confirmed, or flagged where sources conflicted — these require Bloomberg Terminal, Refinitiv Eikon or ICE access to verify. European pre-open futures levels in Section 3 carry a specific data-quality flag; treat with particular caution. Verify all figures before making any investment or execution decision. This document is not investment advice.